Cmd 72

8) Dimensionality Reduction (if needed)

Cmd 73

- The process of reducing the number of features or variables in a dataset while preserving the essential information
- **Aims to overcome,**

1. The curse of dimensionality
2. Improve computational efficiency
3. Eliminate noise or redundant features
4. Potentially enhance the performance of ML models

- High-dimensional data can lead to several challenges, such as increased computational complexity, overfitting, and difficulty in interpreting and visualizing the data
- Dimensionality reduction techniques address these challenges by transforming or projecting the data into a lower-dimensional space, where the most relevant information is retained.

Cmd 74

There are two main approaches to dimensionality reduction:

1) Feature Selection: This approach involves selecting a subset of the original features based on certain criteria. It aims to identify the most informative and relevant features that contribute significantly to the target variable or capture the underlying patterns in the data. Feature selection methods can be filter-based (e.g., correlation, statistical tests) or wrapper-based (e.g., recursive feature elimination, forward/backward feature selection).

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Cmd 74

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2) Feature Extraction: This approach involves transforming the original features into a new set of lower-dimensional features. It aims to create a compressed representation of the data by combining or projecting the original features into a new feature space. Principal Component Analysis (PCA) and Linear Discriminant Analysis (LDA) are popular feature extraction techniques. Other methods include Non-negative Matrix Factorization (NMF), t-SNE, and Autoencoders.

Cmd 75

Benefits of dimensionality reduction:

1. Computational Efficiency: By reducing the number of features, the computational complexity of algorithms decreases, resulting in faster training and inference times.

2. Overfitting Prevention: Dimensionality reduction helps to remove noisy or irrelevant features, reducing the risk of overfitting and improving the generalization

Cmd 75

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3. Improved Visualization: Lower-dimensional data can be visualized more easily, enabling better understanding and interpretation of the data.

4. Enhanced Model Performance: By focusing on the most relevant features, dimensionality reduction can improve the performance of machine learning models by reducing noise, capturing important patterns, and avoiding the curse of dimensionality.

Cmd 76

Principal Component Analysis (PCA) is a widely used technique for dimensionality reduction and feature extraction in data analysis and machine learning. It aims to transform a high-dimensional dataset into a lower-dimensional space while preserving the most important patterns and variations in the data

transform a high-dimensional dataset into a lower-dimensional space while preserving the most i

Cmd 77

```python
from sklearn.decomposition import PCA

# Create the PCA model
pca = PCA(n_components=2)

# Fit the PCA model to X
pca.fit(X)

# Transform X to the new feature space
X_reduced = pca.transform(X)

# Print the shape of X_reduced
print(X_reduced.shape)
```

Cmd 78